

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

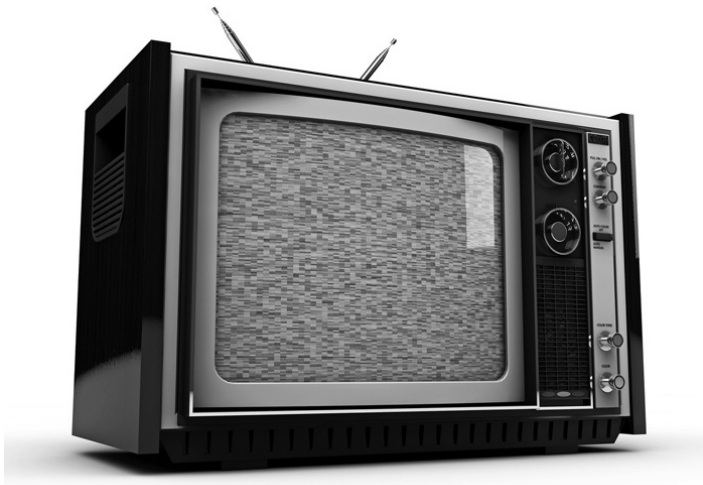
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Let's Start!

Too much violence on TV?



Learning Outcome

Describe unusual events through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- When you were a child, did you ever watch cartoons on TV?
- Do you think movies and TV shows for children are too violent? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about staying healthy.
- I can talk about what was happening when something else happened.
- I can organize points in an argument.





Let's Explore!

Sally blogs about cartoon violence such as people being pushed over cliffs, stretched like rubber, run over by cars, **etc.*** What do you think?

* You use "etc." in writing when you want to show that there are too many examples to write.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

I was talking to my neighbor the other day when she mentioned that her 10-year-old son had started to play more violent games with his friends. She also noticed that while he was doing his homework, he scribbled images of guns and blood. This prompted me to write about mental health challenges among the youth of our modern society.

Which programs on television are the most violent? Detective series, thrillers, science fiction movies, and horror movies may all be violent, but research shows that the most violent programs on TV are kids' cartoons! In many cartoons, the characters are pushed over cliffs, stretched like rubber, run over by cars, etc. In spite of the violence (or maybe because of it), young kids love cartoons and prefer watching them to anything else.

For many years, parents and teachers have been discussing kids and TV violence. Many studies have been done to see whether their behavior is influenced by watching violent programs and movies. Most studies show that the behavior of children can be affected by violence on TV. What is more, it is known that young children in the U.S. watch between 25 and 52 hours of television per week. Therefore, we might be bringing up an extremely violent younger generation! What can be done about this problem? Read my next entry for some ideas ...





Let's Practice!

Sally thinks children's behavior can be affected by TV violence. Can you identify her opinions?

Instructions: Read the text again. Circle the correct word to complete the sentence.

1. Sally thinks cartoon characters - are treated / treat / is treated - violently, and that affects children.
2. Most studies on TV violence show that the behavior of children - can be changed / can be change / can changed - by the violence of cartoons.
3. It is - known / It knows / They are known - that children in the US spend too much time in front of the television.
4. Some things - can done / can be did / can be done - to solve this problem, and Sally will present them in her next blog entry.
5. Do you think children's behavior - is effected / is affected / are affected - by the violence in cartoons?



Let's Practice!

Sally uses some words to organize her ideas in her blog

Instructions: Choose the words from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences.

Word Bank

Therefore / However / What is more /
In spite of the / In spite of

1. _____ the horrible things cartoon characters experience, young kids love them.
2. Violence on TV can affect children. _____, children spend too much time in front of the television!
3. It is a pretty long time of violence exposure. _____, this generation is brought up to become really violent.
4. It is true that violence can affect children. _____, many things can be done about it.
5. In spite of the _____ parents' resistance to cartoons, children don't stop watching them."





Extension Activity

Interview your partner!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Prepare about five questions to ask your partner about cartoon violence.
- Consider things like: When you were a child, did you watch cartoons? What cartoons did you watch?
- Spend time interviewing them.
- Prepare a summary of the information - use discourse markers in your writing.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I talk about cartoons and cartoon violence.

☐ ☐

I write about my partner's opinions.

☐ ☐

I organize my writing with discourse markers.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **behavior** (noun): the way a person acts
e.g. The child's behavior started changing when he was watching cartoons.
- **violent** (adjective): involving the use of physical force, usually to cause damage
e.g. Violent TV can affect children.
- **cartoon** (noun): an animated program, usually created for children
e.g. The most violent programs on TV are kids' cartoons!
- **rubber** (noun): a flexible substance used to make boots, gloves, tires, etc.
e.g. Characters are stretched like rubber.
- **cliff** (noun): a high face of a rock; a precipice
e.g. The characters are pushed over cliffs.
- **to bring up** (verb): to educate or care for a child
e.g. We might be bringing up an extremely violent younger generation!
- **to scribble** (verb): to draw something in a careless way
e.g. The kid scribbled images of guns and blood.
- **mental health** (noun): the condition of a person's mind
e.g. This prompted me to write about mental health challenges.





Learning Points

The Passive Voice

You use the active voice when you want the 'doer' of the action to be the subject.
You use the passive voice when you want the 'receiver' of the action to be the subject.

Active sentence = **Television** (subject) *influences* **children's behavior** (object).

Passive sentence = **Children's behavior** (subject) *is influenced by* **television** (object).

It is not always necessary to mention the object in a passive sentence.

You make the passive form of a verb by using tenses of the to be verb followed by the past participle.

The Simple Present passive form is:

am/are/is + past participle

For example:

*The behavior of children **is affected** by violence on TV.*

The Simple Past passive form is:

was/were + past participle

For example:

*The behavior of children **was affected** by violence on TV.*

You can use **modal verbs** in the passive voice, too.

You use modal verbs to add meaning to other verbs.

They come before the dictionary form (Infinitive without 'to') of the main verb.

Modal verbs can add meaning connected with possibility, certainty or obligation.

For example:

*The behavior of children **can be affected** by violence on TV.*

Here the sentence now has an additional meaning of possibility, thanks to the modal verb *can*.

Examples:

- *Many studies have been done to see whether their behavior is influenced by watching violent programs and movies.*
- *Most studies show that the behavior of children can be affected by violence on TV.*
- *It is known that young children in the U.S. watch between 25 and 52 hours of television*





Learning Points

per week.

- *What can be done about this problem?*

Organizing Points in an Argument

You use words or phrases to organize ideas in a piece of writing. Discourse markers show how ideas are connected. They usually come at the beginning of a sentence.

Discourse markers can show a **connection** to what the writer is saying and what was just written. They can also show what the writer's **opinion** is about what is being discussed.

Look at the chart for some common discourse markers and their meanings:

Discourse Marker	Meaning
<i>However</i>	But; contrast
<i>Therefore</i>	Logical consequence
<i>In spite of</i>	Emphasizing a contrast
<i>What is more</i>	Adding

Examples:

- *In spite of the violence (or maybe because of it), young kids love cartoons and prefer watching them to anything else.*
- *What is more, it is known that young children in the U.S. watch between 25 and 52 hours of television per week.*
- *Therefore, we might be bringing up an extremely violent younger generation!*

